

One of the first moves that Mr. Morgan made, in an effort to quell the panic, was to summon the presidents of all the trust companies. Astonishingly enough, they never before had been brought together.

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*A banking panic . . . is actually akin to that which happens when a leaking ship's company is mastered by fear, instead of a stern captain . . .*

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Well, Mr. Morgan, with his back to the fireplace, watched those men as they gathered in response to his call. In sharp contrast to the linkage of the bank presidents, through their Clearing House Association, and in other connections, was the complete lack of organization among the trust companies. In an angry undertone, Mr. Morgan complained to Mr. Stillman that on this morning he had actually had to introduce to one another the presidents of some of the biggest trust companies. As was true of all bankers, Mr. Morgan had been going without sleep—hurrying from meeting to meeting; at the Morgan offices, at his home, at the Waldorf, or in one or another of the banks. His nerves were raw that morning. He was using every fiber of his intelligence to encompass the problem of a nation. Moreover, he had, I think, a sound banker's contempt for the slovenly banking operations of some of those who were then gathering at his bidding.

Old Governor Morton moved about clasping and unclasping inky-veined hands under the tails of his Prince Albert. As was his custom, he was wearing on his egg-bald skull a wig, one of a series of three that he owned, graded as to length of hair, and which he wore in succession. That old man—he was 83 in 1907—had been Minister to France, he had been Vice-President of the United States when Benjamin Harrison was President, he had been Governor of